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System and method for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution

Abstract

A system is provided for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution. In particular, the system may be configured to generate a secure transferor token on a distributed register, where each transferor token may be associated with a resource transferor within a virtual environment. The transferor token may be digitally signed using a transferor private key such that the transferor may be authenticated by entities using the corresponding public key. The system may further generate a secure token associated with the resource to be transferred, where the token associated with the resource may specify a list of authorized transferors as one of its parameters. Accordingly, the system may ensure that resources are transferred by authorized transferors.

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Background/Summary

TECHNOLOGICAL FIELD

(1) Example embodiments of the present disclosure relate to a system and method for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution.

BACKGROUND

(2) There is a need for a way to authenticate resource transferors in a virtual environment.

BRIEF SUMMARY

(3) The following presents a simplified summary of one or more embodiments of the present invention, in order to provide a basic understanding of such embodiments. This summary is not an extensive overview of all contemplated embodiments and is intended to neither identify key or critical elements of all embodiments nor delineate the scope of any or all embodiments. Its sole purpose is to present some concepts of one or more embodiments of the present invention in a simplified form as a prelude to the more detailed description that is presented later.

(4) A system is provided for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution. In particular, the system may be configured to generate a secure transferor token on a distributed register, where each transferor token may be associated with a resource transferor within a virtual environment. The transferor token may be digitally signed using a transferor private key such that the transferor may be authenticated by entities using the corresponding public key. The system may further generate a secure token associated with the resource to be transferred, where the token associated with the resource may specify a list of authorized transferors as one of its parameters. Accordingly, the system may ensure that resources are transferred by authorized transferors.

(5) Accordingly, embodiments of the present disclosure provide a system for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution, the system comprising a processing device; a non-transitory storage device containing instructions when executed by the processing device, causes the processing device to perform the steps of generating a transferor NFT associated on a distributed ledger, wherein the transferor NFT is digitally signed using a transferor private key; receiving, from a user computing device, a request to transfer a target resource from a transferor, the request comprising a transferor identifier associated with the transferor; validating the transferor identifier using an authorized transferor list within a resource NFT associated with the resource; prompting the transferor to submit a verification data record to the distributed ledger; and based on detecting the verification data record on the distributed ledger, authenticating the transferor as an authorized transferor of the target resource.

(6) In some embodiments, validating the transferor identifier comprises determining that the transferor identifier matches an entry within the authorized transferor list; and determining that the transferor identifier is an authorized transferor identifier.

(7) In some embodiments, validating the transferor identifier comprises determining that the transferor identifier does not match an entry within the authorized transferor list; and executing one or more remediation processes, the one or more remediation processes comprising blocking transfer of the target resource.

(8) In some embodiments, the one or more remediation processes further comprises transmitting a notification to the user computing device, the notification comprising an indication that the transferor is not authorized to transfer the target resource.

(9) In some embodiments, authenticating the transferor comprises decrypting the verification data

record using a transferor public key associated with the transferor private key; and executing a transfer of the target resource from the transferor to a user associated with the user computing device.

(10) In some embodiments, authenticating the transferor comprises determining that the verification data record has not been digitally signed using the transferor private key; and executing one or more remediation processes, the one or more remediation processes comprising blocking transfer of the target resource.

(11) In some embodiments, the one or more remediation processes further comprises transmitting a notification to the user computing device, the notification comprising an indication that the transferor is not authorized to transfer the target resource

(12) Embodiments of the present disclosure also provide a computer program product for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution, the computer program product comprising a non-transitory computer-readable medium comprising code causing an apparatus to perform the steps of generating a transferor NFT associated on a distributed ledger, wherein the transferor NFT is digitally signed using a transferor private key; receiving, from a user computing device, a request to transfer a target resource from a transferor, the request comprising a transferor identifier associated with the transferor; validating the transferor identifier using an authorized transferor list within a resource NFT associated with the resource; prompting the transferor to submit a verification data record to the distributed ledger; and based on detecting the verification data record on the distributed ledger, authenticating the transferor as an authorized transferor of the target resource.

(13) In some embodiments, validating the transferor identifier comprises determining that the transferor identifier matches an entry within the authorized transferor list; and determining that the transferor identifier is an authorized transferor identifier.

(14) In some embodiments, validating the transferor identifier comprises determining that the transferor identifier does not match an entry within the authorized transferor list; and executing one or more remediation processes, the one or more remediation processes comprising blocking transfer of the target resource.

(15) In some embodiments, the one or more remediation processes further comprises transmitting a notification to the user computing device, the notification comprising an indication that the transferor is not authorized to transfer the target resource.

(16) In some embodiments, authenticating the transferor comprises decrypting the verification data record using a transferor public key associated with the transferor private key; and executing a transfer of the target resource from the transferor to a user associated with the user computing device.

(17) In some embodiments, authenticating the transferor comprises determining that the verification data record has not been digitally signed using the transferor private key; and executing one or more remediation processes, the one or more remediation processes comprising blocking transfer of the target resource.

(18) Embodiments of the present disclosure also provide a computer-implemented method for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution, the computer-implemented method comprising generating a transferor NFT associated on a distributed ledger, wherein the transferor NFT is digitally signed using a transferor private key; receiving, from a user computing device, a request to transfer a target resource from a transferor, the request comprising a transferor identifier associated with the transferor; validating the transferor identifier using an authorized transferor list within a resource NFT associated with the resource; prompting the transferor to submit a verification data record to the distributed ledger; and based on detecting the verification data record on the distributed ledger, authenticating the transferor as an authorized transferor of the target resource.

(19) In some embodiments, validating the transferor identifier comprises determining that the

transferor identifier matches an entry within the authorized transferor list; and determining that the transferor identifier is an authorized transferor identifier.

(20) In some embodiments, validating the transferor identifier comprises determining that the transferor identifier does not match an entry within the authorized transferor list; and executing one or more remediation processes, the one or more remediation processes comprising blocking transfer of the target resource.

(21) In some embodiments, the one or more remediation processes further comprises transmitting a notification to the user computing device, the notification comprising an indication that the transferor is not authorized to transfer the target resource.

(22) In some embodiments, authenticating the transferor comprises decrypting the verification data record using a transferor public key associated with the transferor private key; and executing a transfer of the target resource from the transferor to a user associated with the user computing device.

(23) In some embodiments, authenticating the transferor comprises determining that the verification data record has not been digitally signed using the transferor private key; and executing one or more remediation processes, the one or more remediation processes comprising blocking transfer of the target resource.

(24) In some embodiments, the one or more remediation processes further comprises transmitting a notification to the user computing device, the notification comprising an indication that the transferor is not authorized to transfer the target resource.

(25) The above summary is provided merely for purposes of summarizing some example embodiments to provide a basic understanding of some aspects of the present disclosure.

Accordingly, it will be appreciated that the above-described embodiments are merely examples and should not be construed to narrow the scope or spirit of the disclosure in any way. It will be appreciated that the scope of the present disclosure encompasses many potential embodiments in addition to those here summarized, some of which will be further described below.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Having thus described embodiments of the disclosure in general terms, reference will now be made to the accompanying drawings. The components illustrated in the figures may or may not be present in certain embodiments described herein. Some embodiments may include fewer (or more) components than those shown in the figures.

(2) FIGS. 1A-1C illustrate technical components of an exemplary distributed computing environment for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution, in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2A illustrates an exemplary DLT architecture, in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure;

(4) FIG. 2B illustrates an exemplary transaction object within the DLT architecture, in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure;

(5) FIG. 3A illustrates an exemplary process for creating an NFT, in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure;

(6) FIG. 3B illustrates an exemplary NFT as a multilayered documentation of a resource, in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure;

(7) FIG. 4 illustrates a method for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution, in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) Embodiments of the present disclosure will now be described more fully hereinafter with

reference to the accompanying drawings, in which some, but not all, embodiments of the disclosure are shown. Indeed, the disclosure may be embodied in many different forms and should not be construed as limited to the embodiments set forth herein; rather, these embodiments are provided so that this disclosure will satisfy applicable legal requirements. Where possible, any terms expressed in the singular form herein are meant to also include the plural form and vice versa, unless explicitly stated otherwise. Also, as used herein, the term “a” and/or “an” shall mean “one or more,” even though the phrase “one or more” is also used herein. Furthermore, when it is said herein that something is “based on” something else, it may be based on one or more other things as well. In other words, unless expressly indicated otherwise, as used herein “based on” means “based at least in part on” or “based at least partially on.” Like numbers refer to like elements throughout.

(9) As used herein, an “entity” may be any institution employing information technology resources and particularly technology infrastructure configured for processing large amounts of data.

Typically, these data can be related to the people who work for the organization, its products or services, the customers or any other aspect of the operations of the organization. As such, the entity may be any institution, group, association, financial institution, establishment, company, union, authority or the like, employing information technology resources for processing large amounts of data.

(10) As described herein, a “user” may be an individual associated with an entity. As such, in some embodiments, the user may be an individual having past relationships, current relationships or potential future relationships with an entity. In some embodiments, the user may be an employee (e.g., an associate, a project manager, an IT specialist, a manager, an administrator, an internal operations analyst, or the like) of the entity or enterprises affiliated with the entity.

(11) As used herein, a “user interface” may be a point of human-computer interaction and communication in a device that allows a user to input information, such as commands or data, into a device, or that allows the device to output information to the user. For example, the user interface includes a graphical user interface (GUI) or an interface to input computer-executable instructions that direct a processor to carry out specific functions. The user interface typically employs certain input and output devices such as a display, mouse, keyboard, button, touchpad, touch screen, microphone, speaker, LED, light, joystick, switch, buzzer, bell, and/or other user input/output device for communicating with one or more users.

(12) As used herein, “authentication credentials” may be any information that can be used to identify of a user. For example, a system may prompt a user to enter authentication information such as a username, a password, a personal identification number (PIN), a passcode, biometric information (e.g., iris recognition, retina scans, fingerprints, finger veins, palm veins, palm prints, digital bone anatomy/structure and positioning (distal phalanges, intermediate phalanges, proximal phalanges, and the like), an answer to a security question, a unique intrinsic user activity, such as making a predefined motion with a user device. This authentication information may be used to authenticate the identity of the user (e.g., determine that the authentication information is associated with the account) and determine that the user has authority to access an account or system. In some embodiments, the system may be owned or operated by an entity. In such embodiments, the entity may employ additional computer systems, such as authentication servers, to validate and certify resources inputted by the plurality of users within the system. The system may further use its authentication servers to certify the identity of users of the system, such that other users may verify the identity of the certified users. In some embodiments, the entity may certify the identity of the users. Furthermore, authentication information or permission may be assigned to or required from a user, application, computing node, computing cluster, or the like to access stored data within at least a portion of the system.

(13) It should also be understood that “operatively coupled,” as used herein, means that the components may be formed integrally with each other, or may be formed separately and coupled together. Furthermore, “operatively coupled” means that the components may be formed directly to

each other, or to each other with one or more components located between the components that are operatively coupled together. Furthermore, “operatively coupled” may mean that the components are detachable from each other, or that they are permanently coupled together. Furthermore, operatively coupled components may mean that the components retain at least some freedom of movement in one or more directions or may be rotated about an axis (i.e., rotationally coupled, pivotally coupled). Furthermore, “operatively coupled” may mean that components may be electronically connected and/or in fluid communication with one another.

(14) As used herein, an “interaction” may refer to any communication between one or more users, one or more entities or institutions, one or more devices, nodes, clusters, or systems within the distributed computing environment described herein. For example, an interaction may refer to a transfer of data between devices, an accessing of stored data by one or more nodes of a computing cluster, a transmission of a requested task, or the like.

(15) It should be understood that the word “exemplary” is used herein to mean “serving as an example, instance, or illustration.” Any implementation described herein as “exemplary” is not necessarily to be construed as advantageous over other implementations.

(16) As used herein, “determining” may encompass a variety of actions. For example, “determining” may include calculating, computing, processing, deriving, investigating, ascertaining, and/or the like. Furthermore, “determining” may also include receiving (e.g., receiving information), accessing (e.g., accessing data in a memory), and/or the like. Also, “determining” may include resolving, selecting, choosing, calculating, establishing, and/or the like. Determining may also include ascertaining that a parameter matches a predetermined criterion, including that a threshold has been met, passed, exceeded, and so on.

(17) As used herein, “resource” may refer to a tangible or intangible object that may be used, consumed, maintained, acquired, exchanged, and/or the like by a system, entity, or user to accomplish certain objectives. Accordingly, in some embodiments, the resources may include computing resources such as processing power, memory space, network bandwidth, bus speeds, storage space, electricity, and/or the like. In other embodiments, the resources may include objects such as electronic data files or values, authentication keys (e.g., cryptographic keys), document files, funds, digital currencies, and/or the like. In yet other embodiments, the resources may include real-world goods or commodities that may be acquired and/or exchanged by a user.

(18) As used herein, “metaverse” or “virtual environment” may refer to a unitary, persistent computer-generated interactive environment or space that may be accessible by one or more users. The metaverse may incorporate various technologies in creating and/or maintaining the environment, such as virtual reality, augmented reality, and/or distributed ledger technologies. Accordingly, users may access the metaverse to interact with other users, acquire and/or exchange resources, engage with virtual experiences and/or learning activities, conduct business, and/or the like.

(19) Metaverse, as an evolving paradigm of the next generation Internet, aims to build a fully immersive, and self-sustaining virtual shared space for humans to play, work, and socialize. That said, security and privacy concerns (often inherited from underlying technologies or emerged in the new digital ecology) of metaverse may impede its wide deployment. For example, a number of different challenges may arise when a user initiates a transfer of a resource within the metaverse (e.g., an exchange of a real or virtual resource with another real or virtual resource). For instance, both the transferor and transferee of the resource may wish to validate and/or authenticate the identity of one another (e.g., the transferor may wish to verify the transferee as the intended recipient, and the transferee may wish to verify the transferor as an authorized provider of the resource). Furthermore, the transferee/recipient of the resource may wish to verify the authenticity of the resource after receipt, whether the resource is real or virtual. Accordingly, there is a need for a secure and efficient way to execute and/or facilitate the transfer of resources within a virtual environment.

(20) To address the above concerns among others, the system described herein provides a way to perform validation and authentication of resources transferred through the virtual environment as well as the various parties (e.g., users, entities, computing systems, and/or the like) associated with the transfer of the resource. To illustrative an exemplary scenario, a user may log onto the virtual environment to initiate a transfer of a resource (the resource to be transferred to the user may be referred to as a “target resource.” The user may initiate the transfer, for instance, by visiting a virtual hub or storefront that may provide various resources that are available to be transferred, and selecting the target resource from within the virtual hub. In this regard, the transfer of the resource may include an exchange of the target resource with a user supplied resource (e.g., a sum of digital currency or tokens, a fund transfer, and/or the like). In some embodiments, the target resource may be a virtual object or product (e.g., a virtual avatar, virtual good, accessories, tokens or tickets, and/or the like). In other embodiments, the target resource may be a real-world/tangible object such as a product or good that may be acquired by the user as a result of the resource transfer.

(21) The participants of the resource transfer (e.g., the transferor and transferee) as well as the target resource may each be associated a unique identifier within the system. For instance, the transferor and transferee may each be associated with a cryptographic address (e.g., a distributed ledger address). In such embodiments, the unique identifier associated with the resource may be a non-fungible cryptographic token (“resource NFT”) that may be generated by a smart contract and stored within a distributed ledger. In some embodiments, the smart contract for minting the resource NFT may specify the owner of the resource NFT as an administrative entity (e.g., a third party entity that may facilitate the transfer of the resource between the transferor and the transferee).

(22) In some embodiments, NFTs may be also minted for the transferor (“transferor NFT”) and/or the transferee (“transferee NFT”), where the smart contracts for such NFTs may specify certain information about the transferor or transferee, as will be described in further detail herein. The system described herein may be used, in some embodiments, by a third party entity that may serve as an intermediary or clearinghouse for the resource transfers executed using the system.

(23) Authentication of the Transferor

(24) Through the use of the transferor NFT, the system may allow users to safely and efficiently perform authentication of the transferor of the resource. In this regard, the resource as viewed by the user from within the virtual environment may be associated with an interactable element (e.g., a visible token, badge, code, and/or the like) that, when interacted with by the user (e.g., by selecting or touching the interactable element from within the virtual environment, by using a virtual scanner configured to read the information within the interactable element, and/or the like), causes the system to retrieve and/or present information to the user on which entities have been authorized to transfer the target resource. In some embodiments, the list of authorized transferors may have been defined within the smart contract associated with the target resource (e.g., by defining the list of cryptographic addresses that are authorized to transfer the resource, which may include the transferor's cryptographic address).

(25) Accordingly, in some embodiments, an asymmetric cryptographic key pair may be generated for each authorized transferor and associated with the cryptographic address associated with the authorized transferor. The transferor private key may be held and used exclusively by the authorized transferor, whereas the public key may be distributed to one or more third parties. The authorized transferor may publish an initial data record (e.g., the transferor NFT) to the distributed ledger that has been digitally signed using the transferor private key such that third parties may validate the data record (e.g., by decrypting the data record using the transferor public key).

(26) Once the initial data record for validating the identity of the transferor has been stored in the distributed ledger, the resource NFT may comprise a link or reference to the initial data record on the distributed ledger for each authorized transferor. In other words, the resource NFT may define (e.g., through the smart contract) the list of entities that are authorized to transfer the resource.

Accordingly, when a user accesses information about the resource (e.g., by viewing the resource NFT), the system may verify the identity of the transferor against the list of authorized transferors as defined in the resource NFT. For instance, the system may read the cryptographic address of the transferor and verify whether the cryptographic address is listed in the resource NFT. If a match is detected, the system may determine that the transferor is an authorized transferor of the resource associated with the resource NFT. In such a scenario, the system may present a notification to the user (e.g., by displaying a message or alert to the user through a virtual reality display or head-mounted display operated by the user) that the transferor is an authorized transferor. On the other hand, if no match is detected, the system may determine that the transferor is not an authorized transferor of the resource and subsequently take one or more remediation actions. The remediation actions may include, for instance, automatically blocking the resource transfer from occurring (e.g., by rejecting data records submitted to the distributed ledger from the transferor). The system may further display a notification to the user that the transferor is an unauthorized transferor.

(27) In some embodiments, the authorization of the transferor to transfer the resource may be limited by the resource NFT. For instance, the resource NFT may define limitations such as a limit on the number of units of the resource that may be transferred by a given authorized transferor. Furthermore, the transferor may be authorized to transfer certain resources but not others. By setting permissions in this manner, the system may grant granular control over the transfer of the resource to the creator of the resource NFT.

(28) Over time, the administrative entity may wish to add newly authorized transferors and/or remove existing permissions from currently authorized transferors. In such cases, the entity may submit a data record to the distributed ledger, where the data record references the original resource NFT. Once the data record has been validated and appended to the distributed ledger, a permanent record of the change in permissions may be established.

(29) An exemplary embodiment is provided as follows. It should be understood that the following example is provided for illustrative purposes only and is not intended to restrict the scope of the disclosure. In one embodiment, a user may log into the virtual environment to visit a virtual storefront or hub of a distributing entity (e.g., transferor) that may offer various resources or products (e.g., real or virtual clothing items that may be purchased using fiat and/or digital currency). The user may select a particular resource (e.g., a pair of shoes) to verify whether the distributing entity is authorized to sell the resource.

(30) Upon receiving the selection from the user, the system may access the resource NFT associated with the selected resource and retrieve the list of authorized transferors, where the list of authorized transferors may include one or more cryptographic addresses. The system may then retrieve the cryptographic address associated with the transferor and compare the cryptographic address against the list of authorized transferors found in the resource NFT. If a match is found, the system may prompt the distributing entity's system to submit a data record to the distributed ledger that has been signed using the private key associated with the cryptographic address of the transferor. The system may then decrypt the signature of the data record using the public key associated with the cryptographic address of the transferor. If the system is able to successfully decrypt the signature, the system may determine that 1) the cryptographic address provided by the transferor is listed as an authorized transferor of the resource; and 2) the entity offering the resource for sale is indeed the authorized transferor associated with the cryptographic address. Upon making such determinations, the system may present a notification to the user, where the notification may comprise a message indicating that the owner of the storefront/hub is an authorized seller of the selected product.

(31) Tokenization for Authentication of the Resource

(32) The system as described herein further provides for verification by the user of authenticity of the resource to be acquired. Accordingly, as described above, a resource NFT may be generated for each resource to be tracked and/or transferred through the system. In this regard, the owner of the

resource NFT may be set by the smart contract to be a cryptographic address associated with an entity that may possess certain ownership rights to the resource to be transferred. For instance, in embodiments in which the resource is a product or item, the entity may be a manufacturer, distributor, licensor, or any other type of entity that may be able to validate the authenticity of a particular product or item.

(33) Accordingly, a user who is considering a purchase of a particular product or good may wish to verify with the entity that the product is authentic. Continuing the above example, the user may select a target resource to be authenticated. Upon detecting that the user has selected the target resource, the system may transmit a request to the entity's servers to authenticate the target resource. The request to authenticate the target resource may comprise data and/or metadata associated with the resource, including information that may be defined within the resource NFT, such as a resource identifier, creation date, ownership information, authorized transferor information, and/or the like.

(34) Based on the data and/or metadata associated with the target resource, the entity's systems may perform a verification of the data and/or metadata to determine whether the resource is genuine. For instance, the entity's system may read the resource identifier (which may be an alphanumeric string such as a cryptographic hash value) and compare the resource identifier against an authorized resource database that contains resource identifier values of authorized, authenticated resources. In some embodiments, the authorized resource database may be stored across one or more data records within the distributed ledger. In such embodiments, the authentication of the resource identifier may include an on-chain verification by comparing the resource identifier with the authorized resource identifiers stored on the distributed ledger.

(35) If the entity's system detects a match between the resource identifier and the values within the authorized resource database, the entity's system may publish a data record on the distributed ledger that references the resource identifier and identifies the resource as authentic. The data record may be digitally signed using the private key associated with the cryptographic address of the entity (e.g., the cryptographic address designated as the owner of the resource NFT). Accordingly, once the data record authenticating the resource has been published to the distributed ledger, the system may detect that the data record has been published and perform verification of the data record by decrypting the digital signature using the public key corresponding with the private key of the entity. If the decryption is successful, the system may present a notification to the user (e.g., by a pop-up message displayed within the field of view of the user within the virtual environment) indicating that the resource has been authenticated by the entity. In this way, the user may be able to verify the authenticity of a product directly with the entity that has created the product.

(36) On the other hand, if the entity system detects that the resource identifier does not match any of the values within the authorized resource database, the entity may publish a data record to the distributed ledger that references the resource identifier and indicates that the resource associated with the resource identifier is not genuine. Accordingly, the system may, based on the data record, present a notification to the user that the resource is not genuine. The system may further prevent the resource from being transferred to the user or any other future users. The data record indicating the nongenuine status of the resource may be persistent within the distributed ledger. Accordingly, in some embodiments, the initial authentication check may comprise a search of the data records within the distributed ledger to check whether the resource identifier has been flagged as nongenuine. If the system detects that such a data record exists, the system may automatically reject the resource transfer without transmitting the authentication request to the entity systems, thereby preventing the unnecessary use of computing resources of the entity's systems.

(37) Authentication of the Transferee

(38) The system described herein further provides for authentication of the user as the intended recipient of the resource. In this regard, as described above, the system may generate a transferee

NFT associated with the user, where the transferee NFT may be created as part of a user onboarding process. The transferee NFT may include various types of information regarding the user, such as the name of the user, a registered address of the user, user contact information, a cryptographic address associated with the user (e.g., a cryptocurrency wallet), and/or the like. In particular, the transferee NFT may designate the cryptographic address associated with the user as the owner of the transferee NFT, where the cryptographic address is associated with an asymmetric key pair (e.g., a private key and public key). The private key may be held and used exclusively by the user.

(39) Continuing the above example, the transferor or merchant that is selling the resource may wish to verify that the user is the authorized and valid recipient of the resource. Accordingly, when the user requests to transfer the resource (e.g., the user has submitted a purchase request within the virtual environment), the system may prompt the user to input information related to the user and/or the transfer. Such information may include, for instance, the name of the user, the address of the user, contact information, and/or the like.

(40) Once the system has received the requested information from the user, the user may prompt the user to digitally sign a data record associated the resource transfer with the private key associated with the user. In some embodiments, the system may cause the user device associated with the user (e.g., a virtual reality system or head-mounted device) to automatically sign the data record using a private key stored within the user device. If the user or user device fails to provide the private key, the system may flag the resource transfer and/or the user as being a non-authorized recipient and automatically block the resource transfer from being executed.

(41) Upon detecting that the data record has been digitally signed, the system may decrypt the signature using the public key corresponding with the user's private key and view the transferor NFT associated with the cryptographic address of the user. Subsequently, the system may compare the information within the transferor NFT with the information received from the user as part of the resource transfer request. If the information matches, the system may determine that the user is an authorized recipient of the resource and transmit a notification to the transferor system indicating that the user is an authorized recipient. At this point, the transferor may execute the transfer of the resource. On the other hand, if the system detects a mismatch of information, the system may determine the user to be a potential unauthorized recipient and take one or more remediation actions. For instance, the system may prompt the user to enter the requested information once more (e.g., in case the user has made an error in the provided information). In other instances, the system may automatically block the resource from being transferred to the user and/or lock the user from submitting resource transfer requests for a set duration (e.g., one day). In other embodiment, the system may lock the user from submitting resource transfer requests until the user performs an additional verification step (e.g., submitting identifying documents). In this way, the system may provide a secure and reliable way to verify the identity of the recipient of a resource transfer.

(42) In some instances, the user may wish to change or update the information provided in the original transferor NFT. For example, the user may have moved recently and may wish to update the address associated with the user's account. In such cases, the user may submit a data record (e.g., through the user device) to the distributed ledger containing the updated address information and referencing the original transferor NFT. The user may digitally sign the data record using the user's private key to authenticate the transaction. In this way, the distributed ledger may contain a durable record of all of the updates to the transferor NFT.

(43) Processing a Resource Transfer Between a Virtual and Real Environment

(44) In some scenarios, the resource transfer may be a transfer of a real world product that has been initiated within a virtual environment. Continuing the above example, the user may visit a virtual storefront and purchase a resource within the virtual environment, where the resource may be a real world product (e.g., an item of clothing). In such cases, the transferor (e.g., seller) of the product may wish to verify that the intended recipient has received the product in the real world.

(45) Accordingly, the system disclosed herein further provides for verification that the intended transferee has received the resource. In this regard, upon detecting that the product has arrived at the address designated in the request for the resource transfer (e.g., by retrieving delivery information using a tracking number of the courier that is delivering the product), the system may prompt the user and/or user device to provide a receipt confirmation to the transferor and/or the system. In some embodiments, the receipt confirmation may take the form of a data record submitted by the user (e.g., through a user device such as a smartphone) to the distributed ledger, where the data record may comprise an indication that the resource has been received along with additional information regarding the resource and/or the resource transfer. The additional information may comprise, for instance, a description of the resource received (e.g., make and/or model information, serial number, and/or the like), purchase price, delivery address, name of the transferee, transaction timestamp, and/or the like.

(46) The data record may be digitally signed using the private key associated with the user. Accordingly, the system may verify the identity of the transferee by attempting to decrypt the data record using the public key associated with the original purchaser of the product. If the system is able to successfully decrypt the data record, the system may determine that the original requestor of the resource is the same user or entity as the recipient of the resource that has submitted the data record confirming receipt of the resource. Accordingly, the system may subsequently mark the resource transfer as having been successfully completed.

(47) On the other hand, if the system is unable to successfully decrypt the data record, the system may determine that someone other than the intended recipient has received the resource. Subsequently, the system may determine that an error has occurred with the resource transfer (e.g., a mis-delivery of the resource) and transmit a notification to the transferor that the error has occurred. The notification may further comprise a description of the error as well as recommendations for remediating the error. For instance, if the error is a mis-delivered item, the system may recommend that the transferor verify the shipping address and re-ship the product to the intended recipient. In this way, the system may provide an efficient way to verify that the transferee of a resource transfer has successfully received the resource.

(48) Creation and Monitoring of Unique Token on Real-World Resource

(49) As described above, the user may verify receipt of the resource by uploading a data record to the distributed ledger confirming receipt of the resource. In this regard, the resource itself may comprise one or more physical features that may facilitate the verification of receipt by the user as well as authentication of the physical resource to the user.

(50) To this end, the product (or the packaging for the product) may comprise a scannable region that may be scanned by a sensing device of the user device (e.g., a camera, code reader, RFID receiver, and/or the like). Once the scannable region is scanned, the user device may retrieve at least a portion of the information needed to perform receipt verification of the resource (e.g., a description of the resource received, purchase price, delivery address, name of the transferee, transaction timestamp, and/or the like). In some embodiments, the additional information may be embedded within the scannable region. In other embodiments, decoded data read from the scannable region may contain a resource link (e.g., a pointer) to the additional information which may be stored on a remote server. Accordingly, the data record may be automatically populated using the information obtained by scanning the scannable region of the product.

(51) In some embodiments, the scannable region may take the form of an attachment to the product or product packaging (e.g., a sticker, patch, label, and/or the like). In other embodiments, the scannable region may take the form of a woven pattern on the surface of the product in a designated area (e.g., on an interior-facing surface of a shirt). In such embodiments, the user device may be configured to recognize certain patterns within the scannable region (e.g., thread patterns, rivet patterns, and/or the like) that may be decoded and interpreted by the user device and translated to data that may be used to generate the receipt verification data record.

(52) In some embodiments, the scannable region may further provide a way for the user to authenticate the product. In this regard, once the user device has verified that the transferor is an authorized transferor, the system may store a preshared key associated with the transferor and/or resource transfer on the user device at the time of the resource transfer. Once the user receives the resource, the user device may be used to scan the scannable region to check for the presence of an authentication key within the data retrieved from scanning the scannable region. If an authentication key is detected, the authentication key may be compared to the preshared key stored on the user device. If a match is detected, the user device may determine that the resource is authentic, and subsequently present a notification on the user device indicating that the resource is authentic. However, if a mismatch is detected or if no authentication key is found from scanning the scannable region, the user device may determine that the resource may be non-authentic. Subsequently, the user device may present a notification to the user that the resource may be non-authentic.

(53) In an alternative embodiment, the product may comprise an embedded chip instead of a scannable region, where the chip may comprise a wireless communication interface for communicating with the user device (e.g., RFID, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, and/or the like). In such embodiments, the user device may detect the presence of the chip through the wireless communication device of the user device and attempt to establish a communication channel with the chip. Accordingly, once the communication channel has been established, the user device may check whether the authentication key is stored on the chip.

(54) Self-Authentication for a Resource Transfer Request

(55) It should be noted that the processes described herein may be self-executing upon receiving a resource transfer request from the user. In this regard, each of the authentication/verification processes may be implemented as self-executing smart contracts stored on the distributed ledger. Continuing the above example, the user may select a resource to be acquired from within the virtual environment and submit a resource transfer request in the form of a data record published to the distributed ledger. The data record may comprise information related to the resource transfer request, such as transferor information, transferee information, resource-related information, transaction details and/or timelines, and/or the like. Once the data record has been published, a smart contract may be configured to perform verification of the transferor as described above (e.g., by performing verification using the transferor NFT).

(56) Once the transferor has been authenticated, the smart contract may further be configured to perform authentication of the transferee (e.g., by performing verification of the buyer using the transferee NFT). The smart contract may further be configured to perform authentication of the resource using the resource NFT.

(57) If all of the verification checks are successful, the smart contract may be configured to automatically execute the resource transfer according to the parameters defined in the resource transfer request. In this regard, the smart contract may arrange the exchange of resources between the transferor and transferee. However, if one or more of the verification checks are unsuccessful, the smart contract may be configured to terminate the resource transfer. In some embodiments, the smart contract may further be configured to present an error message to the transferor system and/or the user device indicating that the resource transfer has failed and a description of the reason for the failure (e.g., the resource could not be authenticated).

(58) The system as described herein provides a number of technological benefits over conventional resource authentication systems. In particular, by storing secure tokens associated with the transferor and/or the resource within the distributed ledger, the system may provide a secure way for users to verify the authorized status of transferors of a resource.

(59) FIGS. 1A-1C illustrate technical components of an exemplary distributed computing environment **100** for the system for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution. As shown in FIG. 1A, the distributed computing

environment **100** contemplated herein may include a system **130**, an end-point device(s) **140**, and a network **110** over which the system **130** and end-point device(s) **140** communicate therebetween. FIG. 1A illustrates only one example of an embodiment of the distributed computing environment **100**, and it will be appreciated that in other embodiments one or more of the systems, devices, and/or servers may be combined into a single system, device, or server, or be made up of multiple systems, devices, or servers. For instance, the functions of the system **130** and the endpoint devices **140** may be performed on the same device (e.g., the endpoint device **140**). Also, the distributed computing environment **100** may include multiple systems, same or similar to system **130**, with each system providing portions of the necessary operations (e.g., as a server bank, a group of blade servers, or a multi-processor system).

(60) In some embodiments, the system **130** and the end-point device(s) **140** may have a client-server relationship in which the end-point device(s) **140** are remote devices that request and receive service from a centralized server, i.e., the system **130**. In some other embodiments, the system **130** and the end-point device(s) **140** may have a peer-to-peer relationship in which the system **130** and the end-point device(s) **140** are considered equal and all have the same abilities to use the resources available on the network **110**. Instead of having a central server (e.g., system **130**) which would act as the shared drive, each device that is connect to the network **110** would act as the server for the files stored on it. In some embodiments, the system **130** may provide an application programming interface (“API”) layer for communicating with the end-point device(s) **140**.

(61) The system **130** may represent various forms of servers, such as web servers, database servers, file server, or the like, various forms of digital computing devices, such as laptops, desktops, video recorders, audio/video players, radios, workstations, or the like, or any other auxiliary network devices, such as wearable devices, Internet-of-things devices, electronic kiosk devices, mainframes, or the like, or any combination of the aforementioned.

(62) The end-point device(s) **140** may represent various forms of electronic devices, including user input devices such as servers, networked storage drives, personal digital assistants, cellular telephones, smartphones, laptops, desktops, and/or the like, merchant input devices such as point-of-sale (POS) devices, electronic payment kiosks, and/or the like, electronic telecommunications device (e.g., automated teller machine (ATM)), and/or edge devices such as routers, routing switches, integrated access devices (IAD), and/or the like.

(63) The network **110** may be a distributed network that is spread over different networks. This provides a single data communication network, which can be managed jointly or separately by each network. Besides shared communication within the network, the distributed network often also supports distributed processing. The network **110** may be a form of digital communication network such as a telecommunication network, a local area network (“LAN”), a wide area network (“WAN”), a global area network (“GAN”), the Internet, or any combination of the foregoing. The network **110** may be secure and/or unsecure and may also include wireless and/or wired and/or optical interconnection technology.

(64) It is to be understood that the structure of the distributed computing environment and its components, connections and relationships, and their functions, are meant to be exemplary only, and are not meant to limit implementations of the inventions described and/or claimed in this document. In one example, the distributed computing environment **100** may include more, fewer, or different components. In another example, some or all of the portions of the distributed computing environment **100** may be combined into a single portion or all of the portions of the system **130** may be separated into two or more distinct portions.

(65) FIG. 1B illustrates an exemplary component-level structure of the system **130**, in accordance with an embodiment of the invention. As shown in FIG. 1B, the system **130** may include a processor **102**, memory **104**, input/output (I/O) device **116**, and a storage device **110**. The system **130** may also include a high-speed interface **108** connecting to the memory **104**, and a low-speed interface **112** connecting to low speed bus **114** and storage device **110**. Each of the components

102, 104, 108, 110, and 112 may be operatively coupled to one another using various buses and may be mounted on a common motherboard or in other manners as appropriate. As described herein, the processor **102** may include a number of subsystems to execute the portions of processes described herein. Each subsystem may be a self-contained component of a larger system (e.g., system **130**) and capable of being configured to execute specialized processes as part of the larger system.

(66) The processor **102** can process instructions, such as instructions of an application that may perform the functions disclosed herein. These instructions may be stored in the memory **104** (e.g., non-transitory storage device) or on the storage device **110**, for execution within the system **130** using any subsystems described herein. It is to be understood that the system **130** may use, as appropriate, multiple processors, along with multiple memories, and/or I/O devices, to execute the processes described herein.

(67) The memory **104** stores information within the system **130**. In one implementation, the memory **104** is a volatile memory unit or units, such as volatile random access memory (RAM) having a cache area for the temporary storage of information, such as a command, a current operating state of the distributed computing environment **100**, an intended operating state of the distributed computing environment **100**, instructions related to various methods and/or functionalities described herein, and/or the like. In another implementation, the memory **104** is a non-volatile memory unit or units. The memory **104** may also be another form of computer-readable medium, such as a magnetic or optical disk, which may be embedded and/or may be removable. The non-volatile memory may additionally or alternatively include an EEPROM, flash memory, and/or the like for storage of information such as instructions and/or data that may be read during execution of computer instructions. The memory **104** may store, recall, receive, transmit, and/or access various files and/or information used by the system **130** during operation.

(68) The storage device **106** is capable of providing mass storage for the system **130**. In one aspect, the storage device **106** may be or contain a computer-readable medium, such as a floppy disk device, a hard disk device, an optical disk device, or a tape device, a flash memory or other similar solid state memory device, or an array of devices, including devices in a storage area network or other configurations. A computer program product can be tangibly embodied in an information carrier. The computer program product may also contain instructions that, when executed, perform one or more methods, such as those described above. The information carrier may be a non-transitory computer- or machine-readable storage medium, such as the memory **104**, the storage device **104**, or memory on processor **102**.

(69) The high-speed interface **108** manages bandwidth-intensive operations for the system **130**, while the low speed controller **112** manages lower bandwidth-intensive operations. Such allocation of functions is exemplary only. In some embodiments, the high-speed interface **108** is coupled to memory **104**, input/output (I/O) device **116** (e.g., through a graphics processor or accelerator), and to high-speed expansion ports **111**, which may accept various expansion cards (not shown). In such an implementation, low-speed controller **112** is coupled to storage device **106** and low-speed expansion port **114**. The low-speed expansion port **114**, which may include various communication ports (e.g., USB, Bluetooth, Ethernet, wireless Ethernet), may be coupled to one or more input/output devices, such as a keyboard, a pointing device, a scanner, or a networking device such as a switch or router, e.g., through a network adapter.

(70) The system **130** may be implemented in a number of different forms. For example, it may be implemented as a standard server, or multiple times in a group of such servers. Additionally, the system **130** may also be implemented as part of a rack server system or a personal computer such as a laptop computer. Alternatively, components from system **130** may be combined with one or more other same or similar systems and an entire system **130** may be made up of multiple computing devices communicating with each other.

(71) FIG. 1C illustrates an exemplary component-level structure of the end-point device(s) **140**, in

accordance with an embodiment of the invention. As shown in FIG. 1C, the end-point device(s) **140** includes a processor **152**, memory **154**, an input/output device such as a display **156**, a communication interface **158**, and a transceiver **160**, among other components. The end-point device(s) **140** may also be provided with a storage device, such as a microdrive or other device, to provide additional storage. Each of the components **152**, **154**, **158**, and **160**, are interconnected using various buses, and several of the components may be mounted on a common motherboard or in other manners as appropriate.

(72) The processor **152** is configured to execute instructions within the end-point device(s) **140**, including instructions stored in the memory **154**, which in one embodiment includes the instructions of an application that may perform the functions disclosed herein, including certain logic, data processing, and data storing functions. The processor may be implemented as a chipset of chips that include separate and multiple analog and digital processors. The processor may be configured to provide, for example, for coordination of the other components of the end-point device(s) **140**, such as control of user interfaces, applications run by end-point device(s) **140**, and wireless communication by end-point device(s) **140**.

(73) The processor **152** may be configured to communicate with the user through control interface **164** and display interface **166** coupled to a display **156**. The display **156** may be, for example, a TFT LCD (Thin-Film-Transistor Liquid Crystal Display) or an OLED (Organic Light Emitting Diode) display, or other appropriate display technology. The display interface **156** may comprise appropriate circuitry and configured for driving the display **156** to present graphical and other information to a user. The control interface **164** may receive commands from a user and convert them for submission to the processor **152**. In addition, an external interface **168** may be provided in communication with processor **152**, so as to enable near area communication of end-point device(s) **140** with other devices. External interface **168** may provide, for example, for wired communication in some implementations, or for wireless communication in other implementations, and multiple interfaces may also be used.

(74) The memory **154** stores information within the end-point device(s) **140**. The memory **154** can be implemented as one or more of a computer-readable medium or media, a volatile memory unit or units, or a non-volatile memory unit or units. Expansion memory may also be provided and connected to end-point device(s) **140** through an expansion interface (not shown), which may include, for example, a SIMM (Single In Line Memory Module) card interface. Such expansion memory may provide extra storage space for end-point device(s) **140** or may also store applications or other information therein. In some embodiments, expansion memory may include instructions to carry out or supplement the processes described above and may include secure information also. For example, expansion memory may be provided as a security module for end-point device(s) **140** and may be programmed with instructions that permit secure use of end-point device(s) **140**. In addition, secure applications may be provided via the SIMM cards, along with additional information, such as placing identifying information on the SIMM card in a non-hackable manner.

(75) The memory **154** may include, for example, flash memory and/or NVRAM memory. In one aspect, a computer program product is tangibly embodied in an information carrier. The computer program product contains instructions that, when executed, perform one or more methods, such as those described herein. The information carrier is a computer- or machine-readable medium, such as the memory **154**, expansion memory, memory on processor **152**, or a propagated signal that may be received, for example, over transceiver **160** or external interface **168**.

(76) In some embodiments, the user may use the end-point device(s) **140** to transmit and/or receive information or commands to and from the system **130** via the network **110**. Any communication between the system **130** and the end-point device(s) **140** may be subject to an authentication protocol allowing the system **130** to maintain security by permitting only authenticated users (or processes) to access the protected resources of the system **130**, which may include servers, databases, applications, and/or any of the components described herein. To this end, the system **130**

may trigger an authentication subsystem that may require the user (or process) to provide authentication credentials to determine whether the user (or process) is eligible to access the protected resources. Once the authentication credentials are validated and the user (or process) is authenticated, the authentication subsystem may provide the user (or process) with permissioned access to the protected resources. Similarly, the end-point device(s) **140** may provide the system **130** (or other client devices) permissioned access to the protected resources of the end-point device(s) **140**, which may include a GPS device, an image capturing component (e.g., camera), a microphone, and/or a speaker.

(77) The end-point device(s) **140** may communicate with the system **130** through communication interface **158**, which may include digital signal processing circuitry where necessary.

Communication interface **158** may provide for communications under various modes or protocols, such as the Internet Protocol (IP) suite (commonly known as TCP/IP). Protocols in the IP suite define end-to-end data handling methods for everything from packetizing, addressing and routing, to receiving. Broken down into layers, the IP suite includes the link layer, containing communication methods for data that remains within a single network segment (link); the Internet layer, providing internetworking between independent networks; the transport layer, handling host-to-host communication; and the application layer, providing process-to-process data exchange for applications. Each layer contains a stack of protocols used for communications. In addition, the communication interface **158** may provide for communications under various telecommunications standards (2G, 3G, 4G, 5G, and/or the like) using their respective layered protocol stacks. These communications may occur through a transceiver **160**, such as radio-frequency transceiver. In addition, short-range communication may occur, such as using a Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, or other such transceiver (not shown). In addition, GPS (Global Positioning System) receiver module **170** may provide additional navigation- and location-related wireless data to end-point device(s) **140**, which may be used as appropriate by applications running thereon, and in some embodiments, one or more applications operating on the system **130**.

(78) The end-point device(s) **140** may also communicate audibly using audio codec **162**, which may receive spoken information from a user and convert it to usable digital information. Audio codec **162** may likewise generate audible sound for a user, such as through a speaker, e.g., in a handset of end-point device(s) **140**. Such sound may include sound from voice telephone calls, may include recorded sound (e.g., voice messages, music files, etc.) and may also include sound generated by one or more applications operating on the end-point device(s) **140**, and in some embodiments, one or more applications operating on the system **130**.

(79) Various implementations of the distributed computing environment **100**, including the system **130** and end-point device(s) **140**, and techniques described here can be realized in digital electronic circuitry, integrated circuitry, specially designed ASICs (application specific integrated circuits), computer hardware, firmware, software, and/or combinations thereof.

(80) FIGS. 2A-2B illustrate an exemplary distributed ledger technology (DLT) architecture, in accordance with an embodiment of the invention. DLT may refer to the protocols and supporting infrastructure that allow computing devices (peers) in different locations to propose and validate transactions and update records in a synchronized way across a network. Accordingly, DLT is based on a decentralized model, in which these peers collaborate and build trust over the network. To this end, DLT involves the use of potentially peer-to-peer protocol for a cryptographically secured distributed ledger of transactions represented as transaction objects that are linked. As transaction objects each contain information about the transaction object previous to it, they are linked with each additional transaction object, reinforcing the ones before it. Therefore, distributed ledgers are resistant to modification of their data because once recorded, the data in any given transaction object cannot be altered retroactively without altering all subsequent transaction objects.

(81) To permit transactions and agreements to be carried out among various peers without the need for a central authority or external enforcement mechanism, DLT uses smart contracts. Smart

contracts are computer code that automatically executes all or parts of an agreement and is stored on a DLT platform. The code can either be the sole manifestation of the agreement between the parties or might complement a traditional text-based contract and execute certain provisions, such as transferring funds from Party A to Party B. The code itself is replicated across multiple nodes (peers) and, therefore, benefits from the security, permanence, and immutability that a distributed ledger offers. That replication also means that as each new transaction object is added to the distributed ledger, the code is, in effect, executed. If the parties have indicated, by initiating a transaction, that certain parameters have been met, the code will execute the step triggered by those parameters. If no such transaction has been initiated, the code will not take any steps.

(82) Various other specific-purpose implementations of distributed ledgers have been developed. These include distributed domain name management, decentralized crowd-funding, synchronous/asynchronous communication, decentralized real-time ride sharing and even a general purpose deployment of decentralized applications. In some embodiments, a distributed ledger may be characterized as a public distributed ledger, a consortium distributed ledger, or a private distributed ledger. A public distributed ledger is a distributed ledger that anyone in the world can read, anyone in the world can send transactions to and expect to see them included if they are valid, and anyone in the world can participate in the consensus process for determining which transaction objects get added to the distributed ledger and what the current state each transaction object is. A public distributed ledger is generally considered to be fully decentralized. On the other hand, fully private distributed ledger is a distributed ledger whereby permissions are kept centralized with one entity. The permissions may be public or restricted to an arbitrary extent. And lastly, a consortium distributed ledger is a distributed ledger where the consensus process is controlled by a pre-selected set of nodes; for example, a distributed ledger may be associated with a number of member institutions (say 15), each of which operate in such a way that the at least 10 members must sign every transaction object in order for the transaction object to be valid. The right to read such a distributed ledger may be public or restricted to the participants. These distributed ledgers may be considered partially decentralized.

(83) As shown in FIG. 2A, the exemplary DLT architecture **200** includes a distributed ledger **204** being maintained on multiple devices (nodes) **202** that are authorized to keep track of the distributed ledger **204**. For example, these nodes **202** may be computing devices such as system **130** and client device(s) **140**. One node **202** in the DLT architecture **200** may have a complete or partial copy of the entire distributed ledger **204** or set of transactions and/or transaction objects **204A** on the distributed ledger **204**. Transactions are initiated at a node and communicated to the various nodes in the DLT architecture. Any of the nodes can validate a transaction, record the transaction to its copy of the distributed ledger, and/or broadcast the transaction, its validation (in the form of a transaction object) and/or other data to other nodes.

(84) As shown in FIG. 2B, an exemplary transaction object **204A** may include a transaction header **206** and a transaction object data **208**. The transaction header **206** may include a cryptographic hash of the previous transaction object **206A**, a nonce **206B**-a randomly generated 32-bit whole number when the transaction object is created, cryptographic hash of the current transaction object **206C** wedded to the nonce **206B**, and a time stamp **206D**. The transaction object data **208** may include transaction information **208A** being recorded. Once the transaction object **204A** is generated, the transaction information **208A** is considered signed and forever tied to its nonce **206B** and hash **206C**. Once generated, the transaction object **204A** is then deployed on the distributed ledger **204**. At this time, a distributed ledger address is generated for the transaction object **204A**, i.e., an indication of where it is located on the distributed ledger **204** and captured for recording purposes. Once deployed, the transaction information **208A** is considered recorded in the distributed ledger **204**.

(85) An NFT is a cryptographic record (referred to as “tokens”) linked to a resource. An NFT is typically stored on a distributed ledger that certifies ownership and authenticity of the resource, and

exchangeable in a peer-to-peer network.

(86) FIG. 3A illustrates an exemplary process of creating an NFT **300**, in accordance with an embodiment of the invention. As shown in FIG. 3A, to create or “mint” an NFT, a user (e.g., NFT owner) may identify, using a user input device **140**, resources **302** that the user wishes to mint as an NFT. Typically, NFTs are minted from digital objects that represent both tangible and intangible objects. These resources **302** may include a piece of art, music, collectible, virtual world items, videos, real-world items such as artwork and real estate, or any other presumed valuable object. These resources **302** are then digitized into a proper format to produce an NFT **304**. The NFT **304** may be a multi-layered documentation that identifies the resources **302** but also evidences various transaction conditions associated therewith, as described in more detail with respect to FIG. 3A.

(87) To record the NFT in a distributed ledger, a transaction object **306** for the NFT **304** is created. The transaction object **306** may include a transaction header **306A** and a transaction object data **306B**. The transaction header **306A** may include a cryptographic hash of the previous transaction object, a nonce—a randomly generated 32-bit whole number when the transaction object is created, cryptographic hash of the current transaction object wedded to the nonce, and a time stamp. The transaction object data **306B** may include the NFT **304** being recorded. Once the transaction object **306** is generated, the NFT **304** is considered signed and forever tied to its nonce and hash. The transaction object **306** is then deployed in the distributed ledger **308**. At this time, a distributed ledger address is generated for the transaction object **306**, i.e., an indication of where it is located on the distributed ledger **308** and captured for recording purposes. Once deployed, the NFT **304** is linked permanently to its hash and the distributed ledger **308**, and is considered recorded in the distributed ledger **308**, thus concluding the minting process.

(88) As shown in FIG. 3A, the distributed ledger **308** may be maintained on multiple devices (nodes) **310** that are authorized to keep track of the distributed ledger **308**. For example, these nodes **310** may be computing devices such as system **130** and end-point device(s) **140**. One node **310** may have a complete or partial copy of the entire distributed ledger **308** or set of transactions and/or transaction objects on the distributed ledger **308**. Transactions, such as the creation and recordation of a NFT, are initiated at a node and communicated to the various nodes. Any of the nodes can validate a transaction, record the transaction to its copy of the distributed ledger, and/or broadcast the transaction, its validation (in the form of a transaction object) and/or other data to other nodes.

(89) FIG. 3B illustrates an exemplary NFT **304** as a multi-layered documentation of a resource, in accordance with an embodiment of an invention. As shown in FIG. 3B, the NFT may include at least relationship layer **352**, a token layer **354**, a metadata layer **356**, and a licensing layer **358**. The relationship layer **352** may include ownership information **352A**, including a map of various users that are associated with the resource and/or the NFT **304**, and their relationship to one another. For example, if the NFT **304** is purchased by buyer B1 from a seller S1, the relationship between B1 and S1 as a buyer-seller is recorded in the relationship layer **352**. In another example, if the NFT **304** is owned by O1 and the resource itself is stored in a storage facility by storage provider SP1, then the relationship between O1 and SP1 as owner-file storage provider is recorded in the relationship layer **352**. The token layer **354** may include a token identification number **354A** that is used to identify the NFT **304**. The metadata layer **356** may include at least a file location **356A** and a file descriptor **356B**. The file location **356A** may provide information associated with the specific location of the resource **302**. Depending on the conditions listed in the smart contract underlying the distributed ledger **308**, the resource **302** may be stored on-chain, i.e., directly on the distributed ledger **308** along with the NFT **304**, or off-chain, i.e., in an external storage location. The file location **356A** identifies where the resource **302** is stored. The file descriptor **356B** may include specific information associated with the source itself **302**. For example, the file descriptor **356B** may include information about the supply, authenticity, lineage, provenance of the resource **302**. The licensing layer **358** may include any transferability parameters **358B** associated with the NFT

304, such as restrictions and licensing rules associated with purchase, sale, and any other types of transfer of the resource **302** and/or the NFT **304** from one person to another. Those skilled in the art will appreciate that various additional layers and combinations of layers can be configured as needed without departing from the scope and spirit of the invention.

(90) FIG. 4 illustrates a method **400** for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution, in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure. As shown in block **402**, the method includes generating a transferor NFT associated on a distributed ledger, wherein the transferor NFT is digitally signed using a transferor private key. The transferor NFT may be associated with various entities that may wish to register with the system to transfer resources. For instance, a transferor may be a seller of products, goods, or services within a virtual environment (e.g., the metaverse). The transferor NFT may be stored on the distributed ledger and comprise information such as a transferor name, transferor identifier (e.g., a cryptographic address associated with the transferor), registration timestamp, and/or the like. By storing an encrypted initial data record on the distributed ledger, the system may use the transferor NFT as an immutable authenticated record of the identity and/or authorization status of the transferor.

(91) Next, as shown in block **404**, the method includes receiving, from a user computing device, a request to transfer a target resource from a transferor, the request comprising a transferor identifier associated with the transferor. Continuing the above example, a user may log onto the virtual environment through the user computing device (e.g., a virtual reality device or HMD). The user may navigate to a virtual space operated by the transferor (e.g., a virtual storefront for selling various products). In such a scenario, the user may wish to verify that the transferor or virtual space is authorized by the creator of the product to distribute the product. Accordingly, the user may initiate the request by, for instance, interacting with a selectable element or area within or otherwise linked to a virtual representation of the resource. For instance, the selectable element may comprise an interior space of the virtual representation, such that the user may interact with the selectable element by moving a control device into the interior space of the virtual representation of the resource. In other embodiments, the selectable element may comprise a virtual button, switch, lever, or other switchable element that may appear adjacent or proximate to the virtual representation of the resource. Upon detecting that the user has interacted with the selectable element, the system may retrieve the transferor identifier associated with the transferor of the resource. The transferor identifier may be, for instance, a cryptographic address associated with the transferor (e.g., a hash value). In some embodiments, the request to transfer the resource may comprise a request to view transferor authorization details associated with the target resource.

(92) Next, as shown in block **406**, the method includes validating the transferor identifier using an authorized transferor list within a resource NFT associated with the resource. The resource NFT may be a secure token associated with the target resource that may be stored on the distributed ledger. In this regard, the resource NFT may comprise various types of information about the resource (e.g., a resource name, resource identifier, resource owner or creator, timestamp, and/or the like) as well as information regarding the transferors that have been authorized to transfer the target resource. Accordingly, in some embodiments, the resource NFT may comprise a list of authorized transferors, the list comprising one or more cryptographic addresses or transferor identifiers associated with each of the authorized transferors. The system may first search the distributed ledger for the transferor NFT corresponding with the transferor identifier. Then, using the list of transferor identifiers, the system may confirm whether the transferor identifier provided with the request to transfer the target resource (and/or identified within the transferor NFT) matches any of the entries within the list of transferor identifiers.

(93) If no match is detected, the system may determine that the transferor associated with the transferor identifier is not authorized to transfer the target resource. In such scenarios, the system may perform one or more remediation processes, which may include blocking the transfer of the

target resource, and/or transmitting a notification to the user computing device indicating that the transferor is not authorized to transfer the target resource. If a match is detected, validating the transferor identifier may comprise determining that the transferor identifier is authorized to transfer the target resource. In such scenarios, the next step is to determine whether the transferor of the target resource is indeed the transferor associated with the transferor identifier (e.g., the transferor is not an entity posing as an authorized transferor).

(94) Next, as shown in block **408**, the method includes prompting the transferor to submit a verification data record to the distributed ledger. At this stage, the system may prompt the transferor to verify its identity as an authorized transferor. In this regard, the verification data record may be submitted to the distributed ledger by the transferor. If the verification data record is digitally signed using the transferor private key, the system will be able to decrypt the data record using the transferor public key, thereby verifying that the transferor is indeed the transferor associated with the authorized transferor identifier.

(95) Next, as shown in block **410**, the method includes based on detecting the verification data record on the distributed ledger, authenticating the transferor as an authorized transferor of the target resource. If the system is able to decrypt the verification data record as described above, authenticating the transferor may comprise determining that the transferor is authorized to transfer the target resource. However, if the system is unable to decrypt the verification data record, the system may determine that the transferor is not authorized to transfer the target resource and subsequently perform the one or more remediation processes described herein.

(96) As will be appreciated by one of ordinary skill in the art, the present disclosure may be embodied as an apparatus (including, for example, a system, a machine, a device, a computer program product, and/or the like), as a method (including, for example, a business process, a computer-implemented process, and/or the like), as a computer program product (including firmware, resident software, micro-code, and the like), or as any combination of the foregoing. Many modifications and other embodiments of the present disclosure set forth herein will come to mind to one skilled in the art to which these embodiments pertain having the benefit of the teachings presented in the foregoing descriptions and the associated drawings. Although the figures only show certain components of the methods and systems described herein, it is understood that various other components may also be part of the disclosures herein. In addition, the method described above may include fewer steps in some cases, while in other cases may include additional steps. Modifications to the steps of the method described above, in some cases, may be performed in any order and in any combination.

(97) Therefore, it is to be understood that the present disclosure is not to be limited to the specific embodiments disclosed and that modifications and other embodiments are intended to be included within the scope of the appended claims. Although specific terms are employed herein, they are used in a generic and descriptive sense only and not for purposes of limitation.

INCORPORATION BY REFERENCE

(98) To supplement the present disclosure, this application further incorporates entirely by reference the following commonly assigned patent applications:

(99) TABLE-US-00001 U.S. patent application Ser. No. Title Filed On
18/201,424 SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR May 24, AUTHENTICATION USING 2023 TOKENIZATION OF A RESOURCE PRIOR TO RESOURCE ALLOCATION
18/201,427 SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR May 24, AUTHENTICATION OF A RESOURCE 2023 TRANSFER TARGET AFTER RESOURCE ALLOCATION
18/201,570 SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR May 24, PROCESSING A RESOURCE TRANSFER 2023 BETWEEN A SIMULATED AND REAL ENVIRONMENT
18/201,593 SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR May 24, GENERATION AND MONITORING OF 2023 UNIQUE DISTRIBUTED TOKEN FOR RESOURCE VERIFICATION
18/201,336 SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR SELF- May 24, AUTHENTICATING A TRANSFER 2023 REQUEST WITHIN AN ELECTRONIC NETWORK

Claims

1. A system for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution, the system comprising: a processing device; a non-transitory storage device containing instructions when executed by the processing device, causes the processing device to perform the steps of: generating an asymmetric cryptographic key pair associated with a cryptographic address of the user, wherein the asymmetric cryptographic key pair comprises a transferor private key structured for exclusive use by the user and a public key structured for transmission; generating a transferor NFT associated on a distributed ledger, wherein the transferor NFT is digitally signed using the transferor private key; receiving, from a user computing device, a request to transfer a target resource from the transferor, the request comprising a transferor identifier associated with the transferor; validating the transferor identifier using an authorized transferor list within a resource NFT associated with the target resource comprising extracting a cryptographic address of the transferor, wherein the resource NFT comprises a link to an initial data record associated with an authorized transferor on the distributed ledger; prompting, via a distributing entity system, the transferor to submit a verification data record to the distributed ledger, wherein the verification data record is signed using the transferor private key associated with the cryptographic address of the transferor; decrypting the verification data record using the public key of the asymmetric cryptographic key pair; based on successful decryption of the verification data record, and detecting the verification data record on the distributed ledger, authenticating the transferor as an authorized transferor of the target resource; and authenticating the target resource associated with the request to transfer from the transferor based on at least metadata associated with the resource, comprising: determining a resource identifier associated with the target resource comprising a cryptographic hash value; comparing the resource identifier with an authorized resource database associated with authenticated resources; and in response to determining that the resource identifier is stored across one or more data records within the distributed ledger, performing on-chain verification of the resource identifier.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein validating the transferor identifier comprises: determining that the transferor identifier matches an entry within the authorized transferor list; and determining that the transferor identifier is an authorized transferor identifier.
3. The system of claim 1, wherein validating the transferor identifier comprises: determining that the transferor identifier does not match an entry within the authorized transferor list; and executing one or more remediation processes, the one or more remediation processes comprising blocking transfer of the target resource and rejecting data records submitted to the distributed ledger from the transferor.
4. The system of claim 3, wherein the one or more remediation processes further comprises transmitting a notification to the user computing device, the notification comprising an indication that the transferor is not authorized to transfer the target resource.
5. The system of claim 1, wherein the non-transitory storage device further contains instructions which when executed by the processing device cause the processing device to: publishing a data record on the distributed ledger, wherein the data record references the resource identifier and identifies the target resource as authentic; digitally signing the data record using a private key associated with an owner entity of the target resource; and executing a transfer of the target resource from the transferor to a user associated with the user computing device.
6. The system of claim 1, wherein authenticating the transferor comprises: determining that the verification data record has not been digitally signed using the transferor private key; and executing one or more remediation processes, the one or more remediation processes comprising blocking transfer of the target resource.
7. The system of claim 6, wherein the one or more remediation processes further comprises

transmitting a notification to the user computing device, the notification comprising an indication that the transferor is not authorized to transfer the target resource.

8. A computer program product for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution, the computer program product comprising a non-transitory computer-readable medium comprising code causing an apparatus to perform the steps of: generating an asymmetric cryptographic key pair associated with a cryptographic address of the user, wherein the asymmetric cryptographic key pair comprises a transferor private key structured for exclusive use by the user and a public key structured for transmission; generating a transferor NFT associated on a distributed ledger, wherein the transferor NFT is digitally signed using the transferor private key; receiving, from a user computing device, a request to transfer a target resource from the transferor, the request comprising a transferor identifier associated with the transferor; validating the transferor identifier using an authorized transferor list within a resource NFT associated with the target resource comprising extracting a cryptographic address of the transferor, wherein the resource NFT comprises a link to an initial data record associated with an authorized transferor on the distributed ledger; prompting, via a distributing entity system, the transferor to submit a verification data record to the distributed ledger, wherein the verification data record is signed using the transferor private key associated with the cryptographic address of the transferor; decrypting the verification data record using the public key of the asymmetric cryptographic key pair; based on successful decryption of the verification data record, and detecting the verification data record on the distributed ledger, authenticating the transferor as an authorized transferor of the target resource; and authenticating the target resource associated with the request to transfer from the transferor based on at least metadata associated with the resource, comprising: determining a resource identifier associated with the target resource comprising a cryptographic hash value; comparing the resource identifier with an authorized resource database associated with authenticated resources; and in response to determining that the resource identifier is stored across one or more data records within the distributed ledger, performing on-chain verification of the resource identifier.

9. The computer program product of claim 8, wherein validating the transferor identifier comprises: determining that the transferor identifier matches an entry within the authorized transferor list; and determining that the transferor identifier is an authorized transferor identifier.

10. The computer program product of claim 8, wherein validating the transferor identifier comprises: determining that the transferor identifier does not match an entry within the authorized transferor list; and executing one or more remediation processes, the one or more remediation processes comprising blocking transfer of the target resource and rejecting data records submitted to the distributed ledger from the transferor.

11. The computer program product of claim 10, wherein the one or more remediation processes further comprises transmitting a notification to the user computing device, the notification comprising an indication that the transferor is not authorized to transfer the target resource.

12. The computer program product of claim 8, wherein the non-transitory computer-readable medium further comprises code causing the apparatus to perform the steps of: publishing a data record on the distributed ledger, wherein the data record references the resource identifier and identifies the target resource as authentic; digitally signing the data record using a private key associated with an owner entity of the target resource; and executing a transfer of the target resource from the transferor to a user associated with the user computing device.

13. The computer program product of claim 8, wherein authenticating the transferor comprises: determining that the verification data record has not been digitally signed using the transferor private key; and executing one or more remediation processes, the one or more remediation processes comprising blocking transfer of the target resource.

14. A computer-implemented method for authentication of resource transfers using tokenization as indicator of authorized resource distribution, the computer-implemented method comprising:

generating an asymmetric cryptographic key pair associated with a cryptographic address of the user, wherein the asymmetric cryptographic key pair comprises a transferor private key structured for exclusive use by the user and a public key structured for transmission; generating a transferor NFT associated on a distributed ledger, wherein the transferor NFT is digitally signed using the transferor private key; receiving, from a user computing device, a request to transfer a target resource from the transferor, the request comprising a transferor identifier associated with the transferor; validating the transferor identifier using an authorized transferor list within a resource NFT associated with the target resource comprising extracting a cryptographic address of the transferor, wherein the resource NFT comprises a link to an initial data record associated with an authorized transferor on the distributed ledger; prompting, via a distributing entity system, the transferor to submit a verification data record to the distributed ledger, wherein the verification data record is signed using the transferor private key associated with the cryptographic address of the transferor; decrypting the verification data record using the public key of the asymmetric cryptographic key pair; based on successful decryption of the verification data record, and detecting the verification data record on the distributed ledger, authenticating the transferor as an authorized transferor of the target resource; and authenticating the target resource associated with the request to transfer from the transferor based on at least metadata associated with the resource, comprising: determining a resource identifier associated with the target resource comprising a cryptographic hash value; comparing the resource identifier with an authorized resource database associated with authenticated resources; and in response to determining that the resource identifier is stored across one or more data records within the distributed ledger, performing on-chain verification of the resource identifier.

15. The computer-implemented method of claim 14, wherein validating the transferor identifier comprises: determining that the transferor identifier matches an entry within the authorized transferor list; and determining that the transferor identifier is an authorized transferor identifier.

16. The computer-implemented method of claim 14, wherein validating the transferor identifier comprises: determining that the transferor identifier does not match an entry within the authorized transferor list; and executing one or more remediation processes, the one or more remediation processes comprising blocking transfer of the target resource and rejecting data records submitted to the distributed ledger from the transferor.

17. The computer-implemented method of claim 16, wherein the one or more remediation processes further comprises transmitting a notification to the user computing device, the notification comprising an indication that the transferor is not authorized to transfer the target resource.

18. The computer-implemented method of claim 14, wherein the computer-implemented method further transferer comprises: publishing a data record on the distributed ledger, wherein the data record references the resource identifier and identifies the target resource as authentic; digitally signing the data record using a private key associated with an owner entity of the target resource; and executing a transfer of the target resource from the transferor to a user associated with the user computing device.

19. The computer-implemented method of claim 14, wherein authenticating the transferor comprises: determining that the verification data record has not been digitally signed using the transferor private key; and executing one or more remediation processes, the one or more remediation processes comprising blocking transfer of the target resource.

20. The computer-implemented method of claim 19, wherein the one or more remediation processes further comprises transmitting a notification to the user computing device, the notification comprising an indication that the transferor is not authorized to transfer the target resource.
